



Fossils & Geological Time — Make a Cast



What Are Fossils?

Fossils are the remains or traces of plants and animals from long ago! They help scientists learn about the amazing creatures that lived millions of years ago before us.



Fossils help us learn about ancient life



They are found in rocks and soil



They tell us Earth's history



What is Geological Time?

The Earth is very old! Geological time helps us understand the history of our planet.



Paleozoic Era (ancient life)



Mesozoic Era (age of dinosaurs)



Cenozoic Era (age of mammals)





Why Are Fossils Important?

Fossils help us learn amazing things about Earth's history! Here's why they matter so much to scientists and explorers.



They tell stories about the past



Help scientists learn how life changed



Show us how Earth's environment has changed

Let's Make a Fossil Cast!

Now, let's make our own fossil cast! We will create a copy of a fossil using simple materials. Get ready to be little paleontologists!



Clay or playdough



A shell or leaf for imprint



Plaster/dough mix & water



How to Make a Fossil Cast

Follow these easy steps to create your own fossil cast! Each step helps you learn how scientists study ancient fossils.



Step 1 & 2: Press shell into clay, then carefully remove it



Step 3: Mix plaster or dough with water until smooth



Step 4: Pour into mold and let it dry overnight





Great Job! Keep Exploring Fossils

You just made your own fossil cast! Keep exploring and discovering the amazing stories fossils tell.

